

Tiwas RPG Project Documentation

1. Core Philosophy & General Rules

- **Resolution Mechanic:** d100 Roll-Under. A player must roll equal to or less than their Skill value to succeed.
- **Rounding:** All fractional math in the game is rounded **DOWN**.
- **Skill Tiers:** Skills are categorized by Tiers, which represent complexity. A skill's Tier equals the number of base Attributes used to calculate its maximum cap.
- **Failing Forward:** Failure is the primary driver of character growth. Failing generates Experience Points (XP), and failing with "doubles" (e.g., 22, 55, 88) unlocks new Advanced Skills.
- **Exertion Mechanics:** Actions cost resources (Physical Energy or Mental Points) equal to the number rolled on the d100. High rolls are inherently exhausting.

2. Core Attributes

Characters are defined by a 24-point attribute matrix. These attributes are categorized by Body/Mind, primary focus (Power/Speed/Endurance), and secondary application. Each attribute corresponds to a Zodiac Animal and governs a Tier 1 (Basic) Skill.

Characters are generated by rolling 1d100 for each of the 24 attributes.

Code	Animal	Attribute Full Code	Attribute Description	Associated Tier 1 Skill
bpp	Bear	Body Power Power	Body Power Power represents a character's raw physical force and explosive strength, determining their ability to deal massive damage in melee combat, lift heavy objects, and perform feats of pure muscular exertion.	Might
bps	Tiger	Body Power Speed	Measures the character's physical ability to perform forceful movements with high velocity, influencing explosive actions and combat maneuvers.	Impact

bpe	Elephant	Body Power Endurance	Reflects the character's physical capacity to sustain high-intensity physical exertion and explosive force over a prolonged duration, determining their resilience during demanding athletic tasks and extended combat.	Brawn
bpx	Dragon	Body Power Social	Represents the character's physical presence and commanding stature, determining their ability to influence others through raw physical intimidation, impressive physique, and dominant body language.	Presence
bsp	Hawk	Body Speed Power	Measures the character's physical capacity for rapid, forceful movement, determining their effectiveness in executing high-velocity strikes and explosive maneuvers.	Agility
bss	Rat	Body Speed Speed	Represents the character's physical quickness and agility, influencing their movement velocity, reaction time, and ability to evade attacks or act first in combat sequences.	Reflexes
bse	Horse	Body Speed Endurance	Measures a character's physical capacity to maintain high speeds and rapid movement over a prolonged period, influencing their performance in long-distance sprints and sustained athletic activities.	Quickness
bsx	Monkey	Body Speed Social	Determines a character's physical agility and swiftness in social situations, reflecting their ability to use body language, reflexes, and physical presence to influence, charm, or navigate complex interpersonal interactions with speed and grace.	Grace
bep	Badger	Body Endurance Power	Body Endurance Power represents a character's capacity to sustain high-intensity physical exertion and explosive force over time, determining their ability to perform demanding combat maneuvers and athletic feats without succumbing to fatigue.	Toughness

bes	Wolf	Body Endurance Speed	Measures a character's ability to maintain high physical velocity and movement over long periods, influencing stamina-based mobility and sustained athletic performance.	Stamina
bee	Ox	Body Endurance Endurance	Body Endurance measures a character's physical stamina and resilience, determining their ability to withstand prolonged physical activity, resist fatigue, and endure harsh conditions or sustained damage.	Vitality
bex	Dog	Body Endurance Social	Measures the character's physical stamina and mental fortitude in social situations, determining their ability to withstand peer pressure, maintain composure during intense negotiations, and endure long periods of social interaction without fatigue.	Poise
mpp	Stag	Mind Power Power	Mind Power Power represents a character's raw mental intensity and psychic force, determining their ability to manifest powerful cognitive effects, overwhelm enemy minds, and execute feats of pure intellectual energy.	Cunning
mps	Snake	Mind Power Speed	Reflects the character's mental quickness and cognitive processing rate, determining their ability to solve complex problems, react to changing information, and perform intellectual tasks with high velocity.	Wits
mpe	Rooster	Mind Power Endurance	Mind Power Endurance represents a character's capacity to maintain intense mental focus and cognitive function over extended periods. It determines their resistance to mental fatigue, the ability to sustain concentration on complex tasks or magic, and the grit to push through psychological strain when intellectual limits are reached.	Willpower
mpx	Fox	Mind Power Social	Measures the character's mental influence and psychological presence in social interactions, determining their effectiveness in persuasion, leadership, and interpersonal manipulation.	Glamour

msp	Bat	Mind Speed Power	Mind Speed Power represents a character's cognitive processing velocity and mental force, determining their ability to quickly solve complex problems, react to sudden intellectual challenges, and exert dominance through sheer focus and rapid reasoning.	Acuity
mss	Cat	Mind Speed Speed	Mind Speed Speed represents a character's cognitive quickness and mental urgency, determining their ability to process information rapidly, react to psychological stressors, and execute complex intellectual tasks or spells with exceptional swiftness.	Perception
mse	Rabbit	Mind Speed Endurance	Measures a character's ability to sustain rapid mental processing and quick cognitive reactions over time, preventing mental fatigue during prolonged periods of intense focus or fast-paced decision-making.	Alacrity
msx	Otter	Mind Speed Social	Measures the character's mental quickness in interpersonal interactions, determining their ability to react swiftly to social cues, deliver witty retorts, and navigate fast-paced conversations.	Charm
mep	Crane	Mind Endurance Power	Mind Endurance Power represents the character's mental fortitude and psychological resilience, determining their capacity to maintain focus under pressure, resist mental exhaustion, and sustain intense cognitive or magical efforts over long durations.	Focus
mes	Goat	Mind Endurance Speed	Represents the character's mental stamina and cognitive quickness, determining their ability to maintain focus during taxing intellectual tasks and rapidly process complex information under pressure.	Discipline
mee	Owl	Mind Endurance Endurance	Measures the character's mental stamina and capacity to resist psychological fatigue, allowing them to maintain focus and clarity during prolonged cognitive strain.	Resolve

mex	Pig	Mind Endurance Social	Measures the character's mental fortitude and stamina in interpersonal interactions, determining their ability to resist social manipulation and maintain composure during prolonged negotiations or debates.	Composure
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3. Derived Statistics

Secondary characteristics are derived from summing specific groupings of the 24 core attributes.

Stat Name	Description	Calculation Formula
Health Points (HP)	Physical vitality. Damage or energy overflow reduces this.	Sum of all Body attributes (<i>bpp, bps, bpe, bpx, bsp, bss, bse, bsx, bep, bes, bee, bex</i>)
Mental Points (MP)	Mana/mental capacity used for Mind skills.	Sum of all Mind attributes (<i>mpp, mps, mpe, mpx, msp, mss, mse, msx, mep, mes, mee, mex</i>)
Physical Energy	Pool used to fuel Physical skill rolls.	Sum of <i>bep + bes + bee</i>
Speed	Determines initiative or tie-breakers in opposed rolls.	Sum of <i>bsp + bss + bse</i>
Energy Regen	Physical energy recovered.	Sum of <i>bep + bes</i>

MP Regen	Mental points recovered.	Sum of <i>mep</i> + <i>mes</i>
Movement Speed	Base squares moved in a combat round.	Sum of (<i>bsp</i> + <i>bss</i>) / 15 (Round Down)

Note: Characters automatically recover Physical Energy / MP equal to half their respective Regen stat immediately after a test. Full recovery requires a Rest action.

4. Skills & Action Resolution

Skills represent a character's actionable abilities.

- **Skill Caps:** A skill's maximum limit is the sum of its underlying attributes divided by its Tier. Skill Caps can be increased by spending General Experience Points (General XP). See Section 5 for more details about increasing Skill Caps.
- **Base Skill Starting Level:** Half of the maximum skill cap.
- **Action Cost:** Whenever a skill test is rolled, the player expends Physical Energy (for Body skills) or Mental Points (for Mind skills) equal to the **number rolled on the d100**.
- **Exhaustion (Overflow):** If a roll's cost exceeds the character's remaining Energy/MP, the overflow is immediately dealt as direct damage to Health Points (HP).

Advanced Skills (Dynamic Creation)

If a player rolls a **Double** (11, 22, 33... 99) and **fails** their skill check, they have a mechanical epiphany.

1. They immediately create a new Advanced Skill based on the failed action (e.g., failing *Might* to create *Punch* or *Stab*).
2. The new skill is **1 Tier higher** than the skill tested.
3. The player selects one additional attribute to add to the new skill's formula. (e.g., A Tier 2 skill uses 2 attributes; a Tier 3 uses 3).
4. **Starting Value:** The player chooses to start the new skill at Level 1, OR rolls a die up to the new skill's maximum cap.

5. Experience & Progression

Experience Points (XP) are gained organically through completing adventures, and mechanically through failing skill checks.

Earning XP through Failure:

When a skill test fails, the player gains XP equal to: $[\text{Number Rolled}] - [\text{Current Skill Value}]$.

The XP Pools:

- **Skill Roll Pool:** This temporary pool holds XP generated from a failed roll. These points are immediately applied to the skill that just failed.
 - *Naturally Leveling Up:* To increase a skill by 1 point, it costs XP equal to its *current* value.
 - *Cascading:* If the Skill Roll Pool has enough points to level the skill multiple times, it does so immediately, subtracting the escalating cost each time.
- **General XP Pool:** Any remainder from the Skill Roll Pool is deposited here. This pool also holds quest rewards. General XP can be spent at any time to upgrade Attributes or Skills (cost = current value). General XP must cover the entire cost of the upgrade; partial leveling is not allowed. General XP can be spent to increase a skill value above its Maximum Skill Cap (cost = current value).